

THE CROSSROADS

ANAND UTSAV ISSUE



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CONTENTS

THE ANAND UTSAV ISSUE



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FEATURES

02

The Borrowed Dreams Association

How many of us have dreams which are our's ? Are we living our dreams or are we living a someone else's ?

04

Desi Face, Colonial Gaze

Elegantly encapsulates how the 'colonial hangover' continues to live and breathe and how it must be stifled.

06

A Bittersweet Experience

A saccharine infographic delving into the various health benefits of dark chocolate

08

Inside Out

The introduction to CIRS' very own club for our artists to express what truly throbs in their heart.

10

UCL Experience

The scintillating journey of our very own alumnus. Of how CIRS makes a perennial impact on every student.

12

Wall Magazines

A brief description of this year's dynamic wall magazines passionately painted by each house.

01 The Editorial

03 The God Equation

05 Democracy Dishonored

07 Kalavrindam

09 Ink Bharat

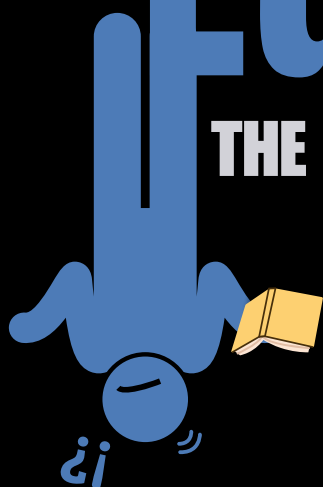
11 A Future Written In The Past

13 Technoxian

Editorial

THE CIRS EFFECT

ARNAV SARAF | GRADE 11, MGMT



In the world that we live in today, there isn't a single 10 year old boy or a girl who would like to come to a boarding school on their own.

Every child's life is totally engaged in Hot Wheels, Barbies and of course, regular treats of Kinder Joy, why would he choose to come to a boarding school? Well, in my case, the one who showed me the path to a hostel was my sister, who always spoke highly of her school. It made my blood gush with the same interest to attend a school like hers. So, when the time finally came, the kid who used to run Marvel Marathons for hours, decided to come to a school far from home, to a school with a difference, to CIRS. And what it held for me, only time would tell.



The year was 2019, the time when calculus didn't exist and everything seemed like life in the meadows. Back then, in the fifth grade, I closely resembled something akin to Humpty-Dumpty. And despite being full of dreams and curiosity, I was too lazy to do anything about it. Seeing new people in a new environment, this place felt like a box with no air in it. But then ultimately it was all about learning to breathe again and that way, I made myself a new comfortable habitat.

Amidst strange schedules and events, I was introduced to one of my earliest passions, Quizzing! Quizzing is more than just answering questions, it's about the thrill, the curiosity, all leading to the final crack. This newfound passion of mine played a crucial role in inculcating patience in me. It taught me to think before acting and minimize any rash decisions.

But after Quiz Club, I had to be subject to another huge fear, exercising! Exercising to me was like the process of chemotherapy for a cancer patient. But, little did I know, it would become an intricate part of my daily life. Another unexpected addition to my daily life, was Corona. The lockdown had me in ruins and I needed to get my life in check. As I grew drowsy, all my habits and discipline were all falling into pieces. It seemed like I was in Goblin Mode every single day for two years straight. Quarantine had made me inclined towards pop-culture and had left just a little corner for any other sentiments. Movies and games were my only workout. There were several pleasant memories, but the ultimate result was bitter.

When the school bells finally rang two years later, sticking back to the schedule was indeed very painful, but this time it was different: I was well aware of my mental and physical condition, and my inner determination had already started to lead me to the right place. I was making a perfect sculpture of myself.



The concept of spiritual classes and evening aartis helped me connect with myself. With continuous introspection, I woke up everyday with the aim to chase a version of me that is ever growing. Holidays and scores came and went by, but the very bricks of my revelation to transform stood unflinching and became a source of constant energy for me. There was a time, when everyday had something new awaiting for me, and to rule that day to the fullest became my aim. Soon, senior school was around the corner. My life went through yet another jerk, but this time I was prepared and it yielded lots of fun. There was a certain element that added masala to even the smallest of things that happened around me, be it the meals at the Annakshetra or morning jogging. Maybe it was my best friends or maybe it was simply the process, which had helped me flow with time and make every single day count here, at CIRS. In a school like this, managing time is just the tip of the iceberg. The real challenge lies in being present at all times, to truly enjoy the experience.

My transformation still persists with great momentum to this day. Earlier, I was still one of those people who fell for the sweet taunting of lethargy and a cozy comfort zone. It was only a matter of a little understanding and courage that made me beat that treacherous ignorance in one fell swoop. Clubs, programs and initiatives that were often talked about were beckoning to me. This made me work on a packed schedule, and it pushed me to deliver under pressure. That pressure served as the cornerstone to upskill myself. I was determinedly set on the path of a polymath.

Now that I look almost seven years down the lane, I have undergone massive transformations. I love exercising now, unlike the old days. I look forward to learning something new everyday, I eat healthy and work healthy.

I try to set my sights on every possible opportunity that piqued my interest. This version of me is more independent and confident. I find peace and happiness in my passions, some of which I had never known of once. Sometimes, I guess solitude is the best society, so that I can earnestly self-reflect. All these years, the friends and the memories that I have made, I know are gonna stay with me till my heart beats its last. I have made them proud and they have supported me all the while. This bond aptly explains what the 'CIRS Effect' contains in its roller-coaster ride.

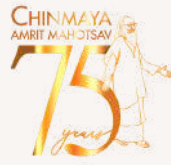
From my side, I was always inquisitive, and full of curiosity which CIRS helped me satiate. If I had the privilege of meeting myself from 6 years ago I would only tell him to, "Take it easy, just believe in the process and live in the moment.

Then, everything else will be just alright." If it had not been for that one school down Swami Chinmayananda Lane, I would have .

What I am today may be the efforts of countless people, but Gurudev and his magical land had a special effect on me like it has on so many others. This effect gives me something new to feel everyday, something new to be challenged. Ultimately, what I would like to tell every single dreaming kid out there is, to not confine themselves to what they currently believe, but follow their dreams, let everything pass through, just live in the moment and enjoy them to the fullest. Do it your way, just like how I did it My Way - The Chinmayan Way.



CELEBRATING YEARS OF CHINMAYA MISSION



In the coming year, the Global Chinmaya Mission celebrates its 75th anniversary. The Chinmaya Mission is the parent organization of the Chinmaya International Residential School, with over 350 Centres across India, North America, Europe, Australia, Africa and the Far East, Chinmaya Mission reaches spiritual seekers worldwide.

Through Vedanta courses, spiritual retreats, cultural programmes, social service initiatives and education institutes, it inspires individuals toward self-growth and service.



At one point in my life, I believed I was destined to be an architect! But it wasn't because I had an aptitude for blueprints, or a love for art and buildings, but for the sole reason that one of my aunts had once told me, "You have a neat handwriting beta, you would make a great architect!" That one sentence led to a thought, and a thought to an idea. Soon enough, I believed I had found my calling. All of a sudden, I was sketching rectangles and pretending they were plans for the next Burj Khalifa!

According to the educational system, by the ripe age of 14, you should identify your talents; by 16, become well versed in them, to the level of a professional; by 18, driven by passion and finally, by 25, you must prove yourself to be an entrepreneur and start a business. Real life though, isn't so peachy and organised. Real life is like a chaotic group project without a leader: you try something, fail, and take a shot at something new. Eventually you realise there's no 'late' and no perfect time to do something. It's only about your pace, your path, your chaos - and knowing that it might just be enough.

After talking about this to a few people, I became sure that I wasn't alone. Most of us have been part of this club once in our lifetime - the 'Borrowed Dreams Association.' Members include kids who choose medicine simply because their dad's friend's son is a successful doctor in the states, and students who pick commerce because they once sold two stickers for a profit in the fifth grade.

THE BORROWED DREAMS ASSOCIATION

AARAV CHOUDHARY
GRADE X, CIRS

The problem isn't the lack of a dream. The problem emerges when 'your dream' isn't totally yours. Another problem is the vast number of deadlines. Oh, the menacing, all-consuming deadlines! Everywhere we go, every thought we have, seems to be some sort of pop up warning, yearning for a result:

1. You're 15 years old, and still haven't figured out what your passion is!
2. You MUST select your career path by next Tuesday... or risk lifelong failure!

You can take detours, slow down, even change directions, because the best dream isn't the one that most people can discover easily or immediately. It's the one that keeps you up at night, because you just can't stop thinking about it. So if you're still figuring it out, welcome to the **REAL** club, where you can find the freedom and ability to make your life completely and irrevocably yours - by returning one borrowed dream at a time.



वेदइं चिह्न COLONIAL GAZE

Chyk

Adhyatma Granthik Agarwal - Jt.Secretary | CHYK - CIRS

From the vibrant spice markets of the North to the sacred traditions of the South, Bharat's unity has been its enduring strength. This rich tapestry of cultures, customs, and languages has woven a unique identity for its people. Yet, the shadows of a 200-year colonial past still linger, casting a long and troubling colonial gaze upon the 'desi' face of our nation.

Even decades after the British were successfully ousted from our land, a more insidious form of colonialism persists: one that has taken root in the minds of the people. This 'colonial hangover' has cultivated a mindset that reveres the West, often at the expense of our own rich heritage. It's a mindset that equates English-speaking with being 'sophisticated' and 'elite,' while looking down upon our own native languages. It's a mindset that allows us to claim to be 'desi' from top to bottom, yet still intrinsically harbor 'The American Dream.'

These incidents, which have often sparked outrage on social media, are stark reminders of the 'club culture' of the British Raj, where Indians were often not allowed in establishments in their own country. The fact that such discriminatory practices continue today, under the guise of 'dress codes' and maintaining a certain 'vibe,' is a testament to how deeply ingrained the colonial mindset is. While some restaurateurs defend their right to set their own rules, the question remains: why are traditional Indian garments so often deemed 'inappropriate' in our own country?

To understand the source of this cultural disconnect, we must look back at the education system implemented by the British. The colonial education system was not designed to empower Indians, but to create a class of clerks and administrators who would be, as a Britisher stated, 'Indian in blood and colour, but English in taste, in opinions, in morals, and in intellect.' This system systematically devalued and replaced traditional Indian knowledge systems, languages, and culture, leading to a widespread 'cultural amnesia.'



The result is a generation of youth who are often more familiar with Western history and culture than their own. They are the products of a system that has taught them to look at their own heritage through a colonial lens, often with a sense of shame or inferiority.



The rise of 'wokeism' has further complicated the issue. While the term 'woke' originated as a call to be aware of social and racial injustice, it has, in some circles, been co-opted to promote a narrative that is critical of traditional Indian culture and values. This has been particularly true in urban India, where Western trends are often adopted without critical examination.

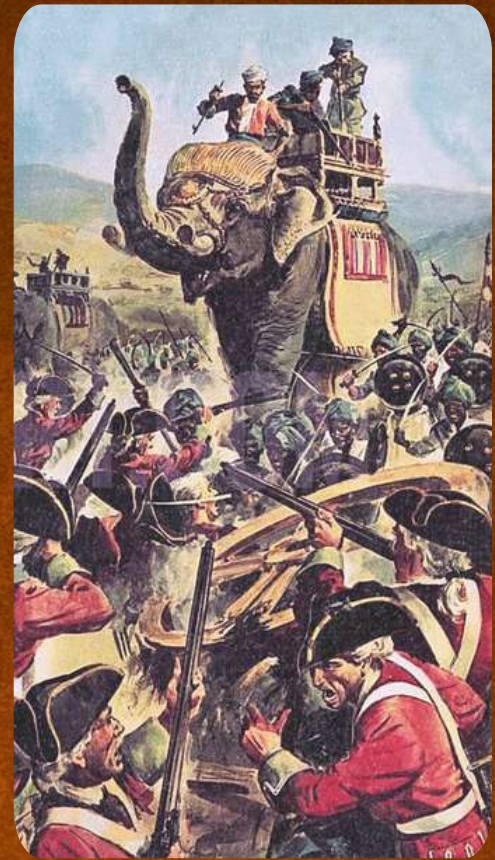
A recent Starbucks India advertisement, which featured a transgender person, sparked a heated debate on this very issue. While many praised the ad for its message of inclusivity, others accused the company of promoting a 'woke agenda' and imposing Western cultural norms on an Indian audience. This incident highlights the growing tension between a globalized, 'woke' culture and a resurgent, traditional Indian identity.

The journey to a true cultural revival for Bharat will not be easy. It requires a conscious effort to decolonize our minds and shed the baggage of our colonial past. It's not enough to simply preach about our cultural roots; we must become practitioners of the culture that has given us our identity.

The irony of this situation is that while some in India are shunning their own culture, the West is busy appropriating it. The international luxury brand Prada, for example, was heavily criticized for selling a slipper that was a blatant copy of the traditional *Kolhapuri chappal*, without any acknowledgment of its origins. This is just one of many examples of Indian culture being stolen, repackaged, and sold back to us at exorbitant prices.

This means embracing our native languages, supporting indigenous brands, and taking pride in our traditions. It means challenging the 'elite' mindset that looks down on our own culture by wearing Indian, by talking Indian, by thinking Indian and above everything else, by living Indian, it means raising a generation of youth who are not ashamed of their heritage, but who are proud to be Bharatiya in every sense of the word. Reveling in that which is truly elite.

The time has come to shed the colonial gaze and see ourselves, and our great nation, through our own eyes.



“I want all people to be Indian first, Indians last and nothing but Indians.”

—Dr. B.R. Ambedkar

वेदश विद्वद्
गुणवद्



THE GOD EQUATION

ARYAMAN BANSAL & DHARUV SHAH | GRADE X, CIRS

This theory is an unfulfilled and undiscovered summit that is left for science to conquer. Within a single framework, this principle can encapsulate every force across the cosmos, and choreograph every discovery, from the motion of the expanding universe, to the minute dances of the subatomic particles.

The challenge was to write such an equation whose mathematical elegance would encompass the entirety of physics. If such a theory would exist, it would be the crowning achievement of Science, a single formula from which - in theory - one could derive all other equations, starting from the Big Bang and encompassing everything until the end of the universe. It would be the end product of 2,000 years of scientific investigation, from the very day our ancestors asked the question, "What is the world, and what is it made up of?" It is a breathtaking vision.

Our universe is composed of four forces; gravity, electromagnetism, and strong and weak nuclear forces. Over the years, scientific geniuses like Einstein, Planck, Maxwell, Faraday, and many more compiled symmetrical equations of these forces. An equation is symmetrical if, after you rearrange its parts, it returns unchanged, or invariant. For example, a sphere is symmetrical because it remains the same even if rotated. Naturally, an equation as vast and expansive as The God Equation would need to be symmetrical. Such a requirement of symmetry would be to bring together the symmetries of each of these equations into one 'super symmetry.'

The Quantum Theory suggested that each force was governed by a particle, called a 'quanta.' Max Planck introduced this idea in 1900 to explain the strange glow of hot objects. But this discovery didn't just change physics – it cracked open a hidden world. Suddenly, reality itself looked less like solid matter and more like a grand illusion, where particles could vanish and reappear, exist in two places at once, or connect across vast distances instantly.

The universe, it seemed, was not a machine made of cogs and gears, but a shadow play of probabilities and possibilities. Though rooted in physics, the idea of the God Equation carries deep philosophical and spiritual weight. It speaks of an ancient longing to uncover a single truth behind all things – a cosmic order that unites science. Einstein once famously said, "I want to know God's thoughts – the rest are details." This quote speaks to the idea that the laws of physics are not just confined to rigid logic, but expressions of a celestial harmony. The God Equation, if discovered, would be the ultimate expression of that harmony – a revelation of the fundamental code behind existence.

And perhaps, in that single line of mathematics, we would not just uncover the laws of nature but also glimpse the purpose woven into them. It could unlock technologies beyond our imagination, open pathways to distant stars and even reshape how we understand life itself. But above all, it would satisfy a timeless human longing – to know that the universe is not chaos, but a grand design, and that we are part of its story.

DEMOCRACY ISHONORED

KRISHNAV DEORAH | GRADE X, CIRS - SUBMISSION TO THE MINISTRY OF EDUCATION
DEPARTMENT OF SCHOOL EDUCATION AND LITERACY, GOVERNMENT OF INDIA

“Democracy is a process, not a static condition, and it is becoming rather than being; it can easily be lost, but never fully won, with its essence being an eternal struggle.”

In 1947, India declared herself a free democratic republic, and in doing so there began an incredible experiment. Few held any hope that democracy could survive in such a vast, diverse, and poor country. But it most certainly survived and in fact, grew into what we now recognize as the world's largest democracy, with free and fair elections, vibrant debates, and freedoms that are taken for granted in many other post-colonial states. But in less than thirty years, that promise was violently interrupted. On the night of June 25, 1975, Prime Minister Indira Gandhi declared a state of Emergency, not because the nation was being threatened, but rather due to the threats to her political career. It was then that a dark period in democratic history began; the dark period when institutions were rendered weak, freedom repressed, and citizens unable to trust their own government.

The Emergency was triggered not by a threat to the nation, but by a personal crisis. On June 12, 1975, the Allahabad High Court found Indira Gandhi guilty of electoral malpractice and declared her 1971 election victory invalid. In any healthy democracy, such a verdict would have meant resignation. Instead, Prime Minister Gandhi chose to cling to power. She invoked Article 352 of the Indian Constitution, claiming that India was facing ‘internal disturbances.’ This phrase became the pretext she used to transform the nation into a dictatorship in all but name. Overnight, the opposition was crushed. More than 1,00,000 political leaders and activists, including towering figures like Atal Bihari Vajpayee, Jayaprakash Narayan, Morarji Desai, and L.K. Advani were jailed without trial. Students, union leaders, and protesters were swept up in midnight arrests. India had turned into a prison without bars.

The press, once the soul of Indian democracy, was silenced. Newspapers were forced to submit their reports for government pre-censorship. While resilient journalists experienced harassment and imprisonment, the compliant ones faded into the shadows. In defiance, The Indian Express left blank spaces in its pages to stage wordless protests, while The Statesman relied on poetry to hint at unpublished facts.



While others stood back, aghast, India - once celebrated as the land of model democracy - was now silencing itself with self-censorship. Fear became apprehensive within India. People adapted to whisper, not knowing what he/she could believe to be true, and what could get them a one-way ticket to prison. But more dangerous than the censorship itself, was the assault on the Constitution. In 1976, Indira Gandhi's government saw to it that The 42nd Amendment, an extensive amendment alternately called the 'Mini-Constitution,' was passed. The amendment further strengthened the Prime Minister's office at the expense of the parliament and the judiciary, destabilized the separation of powers and gave courts an inferior role in reviewing laws, extended the term of legislatures thus effectively centralizing control with the diminishing role of the States. And perhaps most absurd of all, it amended the Preamble of the Constitution, adding the words 'Socialist' and 'Secular.'

These were not additions made through a national debate, but at a time when debate itself was outlawed. The irony was bitter: while democracy lay suspended, the very document meant to safeguard democracy was reshaped under duress. These changes continue to spark controversy today. Were they genuine reflections of India's soul, or political slogans imposed by one leader to suit her agenda?

For ordinary citizens, the Emergency was not an abstract constitutional debate, but a daily nightmare. Under the command of Sanjay Gandhi, the government launched forced sterilization campaigns that targeted the poor and marginalized. Men were dragged to makeshift clinics; others were lured with false promises of ration cards and jobs. Human dignity was reduced to statistics on government charts. In Delhi's Turkman Gate, entire slums were destroyed in the name of 'beautification,' leaving thousands homeless. When residents protested, the police opened fire, killing and injuring dozens of innocent citizens. Every home in India felt the weight of fear. A joke whispered in private, a leaflet handed out on the street, even a casual criticism of the government could lead to sedition. Authoritarianism arrived not with a crown or a uniform, but in the language of 'discipline,' 'order,' and 'national interest.'

Despite these dark times, the Indian people's spirit bore on. When elections were called in 1977, Indira Gandhi was sure that her grasp on institutions ensured her victory. Yet her defeat was stunning. The ordinary people, who had been silent for nearly two years, found their voices in the ballot box, louder than any slogan. The Janata Party came to power, effectively dissolving the Emergency, and the Indian people, despite the hard hit, were sure not to forgo their freedom forever.



They ended up defeating Indira Gandhi. It was a moral victory, and a reminder that democracy is owned ultimately by the people and not by a ruler. Fifty years later, the Emergency is still a reminder that no democracy is fail-proof. The first lesson is simple: no leader is above the Constitution. The Emergency occurred because one person placed herself above law and institutions bent to her will. The second lesson is that amendments to the Constitution must resonate consensus, not coercion. The dilution of the original Preamble is a bitter reminder of how ideologies from the top can be enforced. The third lesson is that freedoms can be short. The Supreme Court's infamous ADM Jabalpur judgment, which ruled that citizens had no remedy even if their right to life was violated, stands as one of the most shameful moments in Indian judicial history. Rights are never permanent; they exist only so long as citizens and institutions defend them.

There is another lesson that is less often spoken of: the way the Emergency has been treated in our history books. Shockingly, this period is often reduced to a passing reference, a footnote in school curricula. Generations of Indians grew up knowing little about the time when their country saw a time without democracy. This silence is not accidental. For years, people responsible for these atrocities were in power, making sure that the full story was manipulated, twisted to their advantage, and often hidden. But a leader who tries to hide the nation's past cannot secure its future. The Emergency must be taught in classrooms not to shame or to score political points, but to forewarn. If our children do not learn how quickly democracy can be lost, they will not know how fiercely it must be guarded.

The Emergency was not just a simple tactic used in history; it was a calculated decision by Indira Gandhi to strangle the will of the people with her own power. It was a time when the press was chained, opponents were jailed, the Constitution was tarnished and ordinary citizens were crushed in the name of discipline. Importantly, it was also the time when the Indian people showed their bravery, restoring their democracy through the ballot box. As we commemorate fifty years, the point in remembering this moment is not to settle political debts. The point is attunement. Authoritarianism doesn't always result in violence. It often arrives in promises of stability or safety or national interest. The true guardians of liberty are, and have always been, the people. If we forget 1975, if we allow it to vanish from textbooks and public memory, we risk repeating it. The true message of the Emergency is simple and uncompromising: Never Again.



A Bittersweet Experience



We all adore chocolate. But how many of us are aware that it can actually offer health benefits? What a blessing, right? Makes me picture an endless chocolatey dream without my mom nagging at me to stop, because it turns out, it can be healthy!

That's right! Presenting to you - dark chocolate! Possibly the best creation of mankind. It's made of cacao nibs, a crushed and roasted version of cacao beans, that are minimally processed, usually unsweetened, and packed with loads of nutrients like manganese, iron, phosphorus, magnesium, and zinc. Additionally, it contains antioxidants such as flavonoids that protect our cells from harmful molecules by bolstering our metabolism. The nutrients and antioxidants that we acquire from dark chocolate are tremendously diverse in terms of developing our bodies

For instance, manganese is a **cofactor** of many enzymes, which means that it needs to be present to activate enzymes, in order for them to perform their tasks. It also plays a crucial role in determining a strong bone structure as it activates enzymes involved in cartilage and bone structure synthesis. Iron is an essential part of hemoglobin, a protein in the RBC that helps deliver oxygen throughout our bodies. Magnesium, another cofactor of enzymes, helps regulate more than 300 biochemical reactions in our bodies!

Zinc helps in fighting numerous infections and reduces the duration and severity of colds. It speeds up skin and tissue repairs, reduces the risk of depression and even age-related cognitive decline. As for the antioxidants, they are vital in maintaining cardiovascular health and obstructing the growth of cancer cells.

Flavonoids help inhibit the growth of cancer cells, block tumor development, slow down the aging process, and decrease the risk of chronic diseases. Moreover, they reduce blood pressure and help in preventing heart diseases by lowering bad cholesterol (LDL).

So, the next time you visit a supermarket, don't reach for the same old milk chocolate made of cocoa beans, which in fact spike up blood sugar levels and cause your heartbeat to go haywire. Make sure to consider this delectable treat and the wonders it does for you.



KALAVRINDAM

CIRS Art Initiative

A studio, flooded with creativity and color. Art pieces hanging on every wall of this campus. Students who find art to be an integral part of their daily lives, be it doodling on the back of textbooks, or making patterns in sand during 5-on-5s and CCKs. These sparks of creativity play a vital role in sculpting one's character and articulating one's thoughts. We found art to be effective in kindling dynamism and instilling calmness even in the most stressful situations.

There was only one thing missing in our school. A place for these ideas to take off. A place where these hidden artists can thrive. That's where we come into the picture - कलावृन्दम्. This club has been bestowed with a responsibility - the responsibility of bringing art to the masses, and not confining art to strokes on canvases, instead fostering any form of art which brings expression. We believe that there is no specific format, syllabus or criteria that define 'Art'.

The satisfaction you feel after completing an art piece, the relaxation you get from just looking at the finished masterpiece, is all you need to be an artist. With the guidance of Smt. Sharanya, our beloved head of the art department, and all the art teachers who helped turn a fledgling idea of ours into a reality.

Our first session was for the tiny *Da Vincis* and *Van Goghs* of 5th and 6th grade. We taught them the very basics of art, beginning with the color wheel. Following this, they were taught the various applications of color theory in fashion. We even encouraged them to wear complementary colors during their Sunday aartis!

After this we conducted a session for 8th graders. This session was about dissecting Vincent Van Gogh's famous post-Impressionist landscape 'The Starry Night.' We divided this complicated piece into layers and taught students how to make their own paintings easy, yet appear complex.

Our next idea was accessories. It's long been fashionable to wear bracelets of all sorts around our wrists, so why not make one for ourselves? We chose the 10th graders for this task. They made the sessions worthwhile, filled with learning, and took with them elegantly crafted beads with well chosen shapes and colors. This success motivated us to conduct another bead-making workshop for grade 7. This batch of kids were filled with energy and enthusiasm. They didn't catch on to the art at first, but learnt from their mistakes and made their own masterpieces.

Throughout the sessions, we enjoyed watching every participant discover the artist within themselves. Every "Wow! I did not know I could be good at this!" made our day. It gave us a purpose to work for. This little idea that sparked in our minds is now growing like a lamp and will soon be a fire in the heart of every young artist in our campus, and hopefully beyond. We believe that there is an artist in everyone. We are just the brushes which will help them paint their canvases.



insideout

the dance of thoughts

HIYA DEEP DAVE
GRADE XII, CIRS

Standing on the stage, waiting for the performance to begin. A hundred spotlights, a thousand eyes hovering on the outside, while eager expectations and a million thoughts run rampant within, battling each other and making me numb. In that chaos, there is just one voice that echoes clearly. That voice belongs to my guru, my only guide in the darkness. "Dance with your heart, express yourself and your emotions freely, and your feet will follow."

Every dancer's performance may seem like a simple act to the layman's eye, but actually follows a magnificent journey of learning and molding oneself, seen mainly through the lens of one's emotions. Every act performed on the stage changes the perspective of the dancer, teaching them a plethora of things. It changes their way of reacting to situations, and redefines how each emotion is felt and expressed, affecting their perception of themselves and others.

"*Yato hastas tato drishti*"..."Where the hand gestures, the eyes follow"

"*Yato drishtis tato manaha*"..."Where the eyes go, the mind follows"

"*Yato manas tato bhavah*"..."Where the mind goes, there the *bhava* (expression) forms"

"*Yato bhavas tato rasah*"..."Where there is expression (*bhava*), the emotion or mood (*rasa*) is evoked."

As rightly said in the aforementioned shloka, all the inner chatter, every hope, question and nervous leap stuck in my mind, finds its way out through my dance. My hands set the intention, my eyes follow, and suddenly my mind is right there, present and alive. The moment when my thoughts line up with my movements, and what I feel inside starts to show in my expressions, that is when the real emotion, or the *rasā*, flows through not just me, but everyone watching. It's not just choreographed movements, but my inner world dancing its way out, frame by frame. Whenever I'm on that stage, it's more than just a performance. It's a serene harmony between my dance and my emotions, and it brings me to the present like nothing else. This is why each performance feels so personal for me.

The moments when I am dancing are the only ones I can truly express my emotions, without any barriers and any questions raised. In those moments alone, I am truly free. Every emotion that I'd suppressed throughout the day, whenever I felt that it was wrong to express it openly, and that judgement would raise its ugly head at what I wanted to show, finally flows out. It is my source of happiness and an integral part of my life, a part where I am just me and everything that I hold inside me expresses itself in the most elegant, yet powerful way.

Dancing for me is more than just an art. It is my form of *sadhana* - an offering to the divine. It is an opportunity where I find my sense of mental peace, a place where I can truly express everything that whirls inside my mind. Every movement helps purify my mind, awaken my energy and mirror the battles and choices within me, allowing emotions and thoughts to flow freely through rhythm, breath, and gesture.



INK-BHARAT

ESSAY WRITING COMPETITION WINNER

HARSHITA BONDIA
GRADE X, CIRS

Suppose you were a revolutionary in the times of British oppression. Write an article invoking nationalistic fervor in the hearts of Indians, to be published in a newspaper.

The land on which Shri Ram walked, in which Krishna's enchanting music swirled with the wind, in which *Dharma* ALWAYS won. The land of Bharat. OUR Bharat. For how long shall we sit quietly while hundreds of our peoples' chests are mercilessly pierced by British bullets? For how long shall we, the children of Bharat, be slaves in our own home?

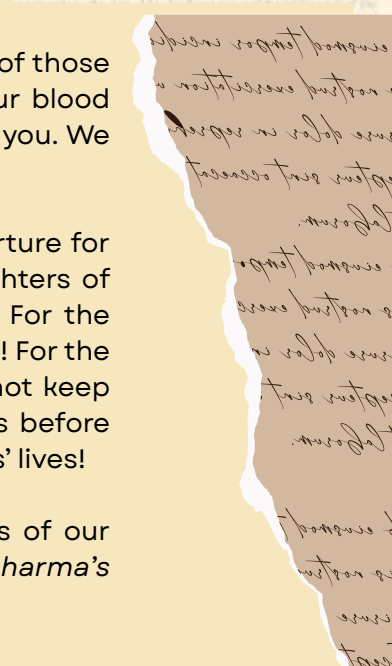
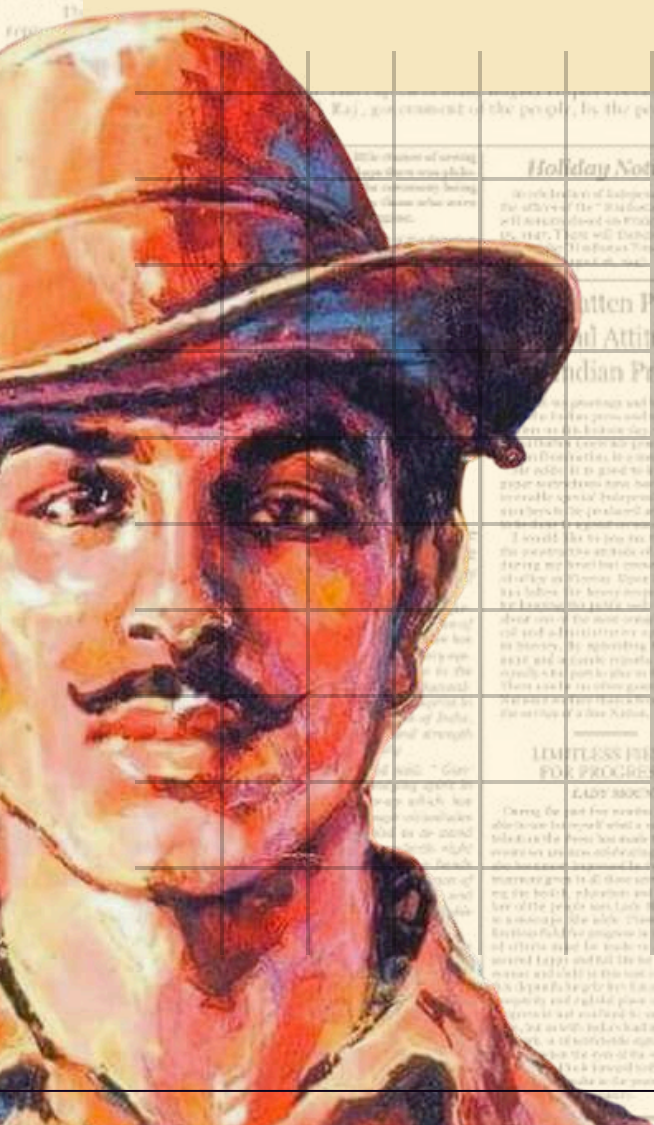
They turned our festivals into funerals and reduced our temples to rubble. The laughs and smiles, once abundant, are now replaced by the sound of bullets tearing through the air! But we shall never give up. We shall fight and fight for the mother who fed us every grain sown in her. The mother who gave us our identities. Remember that we are all children of one mother, who has given and ceaselessly kept giving to us. We are Bharatiyas. It is our *swadharma* to protect this land and chase these Britishers away! Thousands of our brothers and sisters were killed ruthlessly in Jallianwala Bagh. Thousands of children, who never walked the soil of their nation. Thousands of *Bharatiyas* whose eyes were empty, devoid of even a flicker of light.

How can these Britishers rule over us if we all unite as one? How can they disrespect the great saints and poets who sang and composed on the very banks of Mother Ganga to spread their knowledge to us, if we begin to appreciate their contributions? How can they pass doctrines against the very mothers and sisters we see as *Devi Herself*??

Every insult struck like lightning in the veins of those who rose, for you. Every unjust act made our blood boil, for you. Every revolt made us starve, for you. We envisioned *Swaraj* so you could live freely.

We went through unimaginable pain and torture for YOU and you alone. So rise, sons and daughters of Bharat, for the mother who nourished you! For the kings and queens who gave their lives for you! For the children who never saw this land! We shall not keep quiet anymore! We shall not hang our heads before those very tyrants who took away our peoples' lives!

The time has come to replace the screams of our brothers and sisters with the clarion call of *Dharma's* conches!





UCL

EXPERIENCE

ARMAN AGARWALA | ALUMNUS | BATCH OF 2022

When I look back at my time at CIRS, it doesn't feel like just a simple five years of education, but rather the place which raised me and made me who I am today. Hostel life means that every single day is different from the other. The classrooms, hostels, sports fields, even the dining hall... They all became pieces of what felt like one big extended home. Now, sitting here in London, right as I begin my journey at the University College London, I can clearly see how much those 5 years shaped me.



Hostel life at CIRS cannot be defined in a few lines. We learnt how to be independent while maintaining our connections,

waking up together at terrifying hours of the day, jogging in the Arjuna, going through our daily routines, and concluding the day with seemingly endless dorm conversations. Memories of exam nights, when we would all gather in the common room and try our absolute best to study and the daily sessions engaging in banter, still make me smile. Somehow, that combination of stress and laughter made everything bearable, and the small tokens of encouragement from those days gave me a confidence that I still possess, all the way in London.

Of course, life at UCL is a whole another world. With students from around the globe, it's one of the finest universities in the world. With lectures, homework, projects, and countless opportunities, fighting for attention, the pace of everyday life is fast, and doesn't pause for anyone. On the other hand, I feel prepared for all the chaos I face, all because of CIRS. I have learnt how to manage deadlines, appreciate various cultures, and above all, stand up for myself and my values.

The learnings from Swamiji at CIRS are something that I remember the most. School always reminded us that, 'The future of our world rests upon the quality of its youth.' I can see how true that is here at UCL, where I'm surrounded by such a diverse group of young people, who are going to be the next leaders of the world. I learnt from CIRS that education is not just about getting good grades or earning more accomplishments. Improving oneself as a person is just as important. Making the transition isn't



always easy, though. There are times when I really miss living in a hostel, the Annakshetra meals, the celebrations of Onam and Diwali or just knowing that your best friends are in the next room. Nevertheless, every time I feel that way, I remind myself of the resilience that CIRS had instilled in me, to maintain self-control, confront challenges, and keep moving forward constructively.

So to everyone still at CIRS: enjoy every moment. The friendships, the hostel fun, the lessons inside and outside the classrooms – they'll stay with you far longer than you think. And one day, when you step into a brand-new world, you'll realize just how prepared your years here made you.

CIRS will always be my foundation. Even here in London, as I take on this

exciting new chapter at UCL, I don't just carry memories of school. Instead I carry the values, confidence, and spirit that CIRS gave me for life.

As I look through all my years in that hallowed institution I was equipped with the central idea of what the school wanted to instill in all of its students - Service Above Self.



A FUTURE WRITTEN IN THE PAST



- AAYUSH SREENATH, IB-I, CIRS

*A faceless visage, carved and mocked by society's hands,
A heart splintered, screaming, yet no one understands,
Two arms locked tight in iron wings of cold conformity,
One mouth, stitched with black thread, bound in fear's deformity;
Two eyes - blank, hollow, drowning in salt-made seas,
Their tears, the only witness to a thousand silent pleas.*

Is this a woman?

*Bound by laws she never wrote,
Dismissed as a shadow, a whisper, a note.
Condemned without knowing her crime,
Banished with a knot, a cord, a tradition through time.*

*Was birth itself the sin?
Was duty a noose, dressed as kin?
From the hour she entered this world's cold gate,
To the minute it closed, sealing her fate,
She asked herself,
Was all of this a blessing or a curse?
Life or a sentence rehearsed,*

*Did her will matter at all?
Or was she destined to fall?*

*For until her final breath,
Her fate was scrawled in old ink's cast;
A future already written,
Entombed in the past.*



Wall MAGAZINES

“கலையில் கரைந்தேன், அகந்தை அழித்தேன்”
It is in this surrender that the divine begins to speak.

This experience mirrors the beliefs of Vyasa House - peace as the foundation of being, purity as the essence of devotion and silence as the highest form of truth. To dissolve in art is simply to grasp divinity itself - where the soul finds rest, the heart finds clarity and the self simply ceases to exist.



சೌந்தರ್யத்தில் லுப்தே
In fierceness, lies beauty

Just like the performer, we become the divine itself, carrying responsibility, faith and justice on each other's shoulders. Ever upholding peace, prosperity and perseverance around us, the Vishwamitra house proudly holds the green flag high.



Like the Theyyam, we wear our red with pride – fierce, passionate, and unstoppable. The fire around us does not burn us down; it makes us rise, roar, and reign. We are the blaze. We are the storm. We are Vasishta – BORN TO TRIUMPH



Amidst the crimson festivities, she stands tall. Her devotion is her unfathomable power and magnificent radiance - as a mother, a daughter, a sister, and above all, Devi. She engages in Sindoor Khel, a tribute to mother Durga and a powerful act of establishing her legacy of divine strength and grandeur. The strength and grandeur of the Valmiki House.



TECHNOXIAN

JASHITH AGARWAL
GRADE IX, CIRS

"It is not Faith in Technology . It is Faith in people"

The air in Noida crackled with an energy I had never felt before. It wasn't the heat or the city's pulse, but an intangible, electrical charge of ambition, an underlying beat that called to us. Our team from CIRS wasn't just there to compete. We had travelled over 2400 km, to throw our hats into the global ring of mechanics. This was Technoxian 9.0, a World Robotics Championship that had just shattered a record by bringing together over 60 countries in the single, mind-blowing arena of geniuses.

The journey was a testament to our commitment. Our preparation for Technoxian was a marathon of dedication, stretching over four months. We spent innumerable weekends and late nights huddled in our school, our hands stained with solder while our minds buzzed with endless lines of code. The project was our shared obsession, an obsession of perfection, a near-living thing we built from scratch, fueled by a collective dream to create something truly innovative. After our masterpiece was ready, we were all set to fly out and face the world.

Our project, the 'AARM,' is a real game changer. It is an efficient, brand new way to solve dangerous conflicts between people and the wildlife that surrounds them. The idea came from a shocking fact: during the 2004 tsunami, over 150,000 people died, while only a few animals did. This showed us that animals have an incredible ability to sense danger! AARM copies this natural alarm. It uses infrasound – low-frequency sound waves that people can't hear – to act as an invisible, harmless fence. Since it's powered by solar energy and uses AI to spot animals, AARM is a gentle and smart solution to protect both homes and endangered species

Forget our typical school science fair. This competition was a technological colosseum, and every second spent preparing was worth the effort. The hall was a vibrant collection of flags and languages. Teams from Russia, Iran, Iraq, Nepal, China and a dozen other nations moved with purpose, their faces a mixture of intense focus and a shared, unspoken thrill. We watched as a Russian team's drone navigated an obstacle course with surgical precision. We exchanged nervous smiles with an Iranian team whose robot was the crown jewel of the event. This was real education, not from a text book, but from the raw, unfiltered exchange of ideas with the world's most brilliant young minds. It was a humbling and overwhelming experience. We weren't just representing our school, we were carrying the pride of India onto a global stage.



Our final battle was the Innovation Challenge. The stakes were astronomical. Our project, which was the sum of countless sleepless nights and redesigned prototypes, was now our only ticket to glory. We had poured our hearts into this creation, with every failure and malfunction only creating an unquenchable determination. We were building more than just a machine. We were building and witnessing our dream come to life.

The presentation felt like a performance under a spotlight. We stood before a panel of international judges, their expressions unreadable and their questions cutting right to the core of our work. We spoke with confidence, pushed forward by an internal urge to 'just do it.'

Then came the moment that made our hearts skip a beat - the award ceremony. The names of the winners echoed through the hall and our anticipation built with every person climbing onto the stage.

When they announced that the fourth place in the Innovation Challenge goes to the team representing India, from CIRS, a roar of triumph worked its way out from within our hearts. It wasn't the first place, but we had struggled against the world's finest teams and proven that our innovation was a force to be reckoned with. We really felt like we deserved a place among such a vast talent group. India had secured her place among the top innovators on the global stage, while we created our mark as international winners.

We left Noida with something far more profound than a trophy, certificate or prize. We left with a global network of friends and a renewed sense of purpose, along with the powerful realization that with enough passion and determination, no dream is too small, and no challenge is too big. After all, if a group of students from Coimbatore could make their mark on the entire world, then this wasn't just a competition - it was a dream come true. We had just built the launchpad of our dreams.



"As the new team begins their journey, we wish them all the best as they reach new heights of literary excellence. We express our heartfelt gratitude to the Crossroads for giving us this opportunity to learn and grow."

-Editorial Team 2024

DexConnect

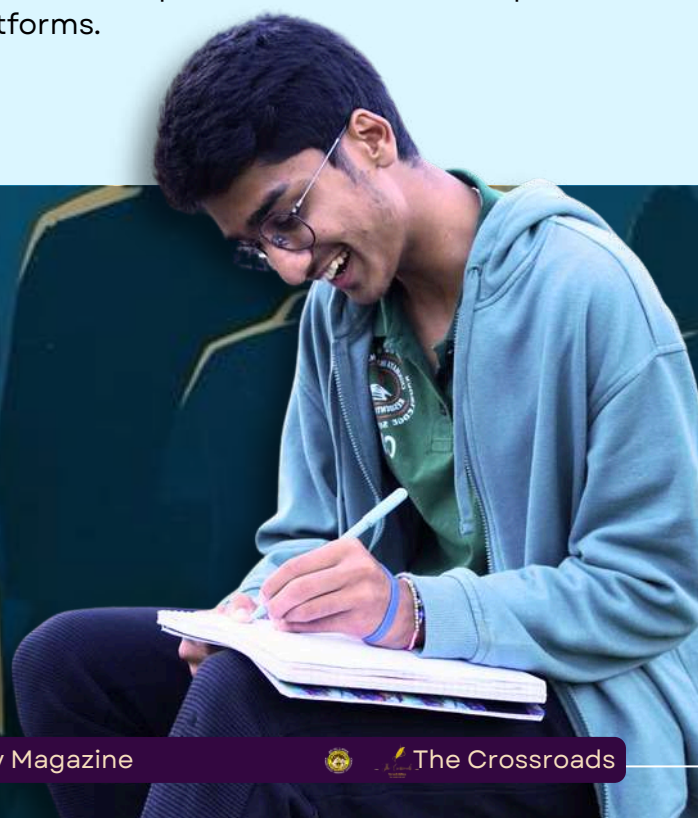
Our students at CIRS were recently introduced to an opportunity to help build their profiles and empower their Curriculum Vitae for the future. DexConnect by Dexterity Global is a global platform that facilitates student participation in various competitions aimed at nurturing essential skills for the future.

It curates world-class competitions/fellowships and research opportunities across a range of academic and co-curricular interests, ensuring students can showcase their talents while connecting with peers from International backgrounds. By bundling up several prestigious international and national competitions, all in a neatly presented email, DexConnect aspires to empower students with the tools to address modern challenges. Each opportunity is accompanied with its own set of resource links, which thus adds to upskilling of the participant. DexConnect's 'Opportunity Superhighway' connects schools, libraries, and nonprofits, enabling even students from underserved communities to excel globally. Leadership is defined as, "the ability to deliver value through whatever limited expertise you possess." Having a vision for the future will give you a start, but Dexconnects provide our students with an opportunity to equip themselves with domain expertise as exceptional global scholars, helping you to achieve that vision.

In CIRS, these opportunities have shaped the view and have built the concept of healthy competition in the students who participate. "Just looking at the sheer skill level of participants made me re-look at my own efforts in becoming an International photographer", says Vivaan Jain of Grade 12 who participated in the New York Times photo essay competition and placed top 50 Globally. Through him CIRS had the unique opportunity to be placed as one of the 3 Indian Schools on the New York Times Global list. "I fell in love with the concept, and of course a 100,000\$ prize money is nothing to scoff at" says Viraj V Lal of Grade 10, who is diligently preparing to crack the Breakthrough Junior Challenge, which is an international science short film making competition founded in 2015 by Yuri and Julia Miller of the Breakthrough Price foundation. This 'Opportunity Superhighway' exposes them to elite experiences from Harvard, Yale, the United Nations, IITs and IIMs across the country, and other renowned and globally recognized institutions. Through this platform, these young leaders of tomorrow truly broaden and mature their perspective of the world, realizing how much more they have to offer.

Currently we have around a 100 students participating in DexConnects across senior school. No month goes by without them waiting to open up their Inbox on the first Sunday discovering upwards of 30 competitions to help them increase their exposure and their level of competence on global platforms.

"This 'Opportunity Superhighway' exposes them to elite experiences from Harvard, Yale, the United Nations, IITs and IIMs across the country, and other renowned and globally recognized institutions."



CAPTURES







CREATIVE CORNER



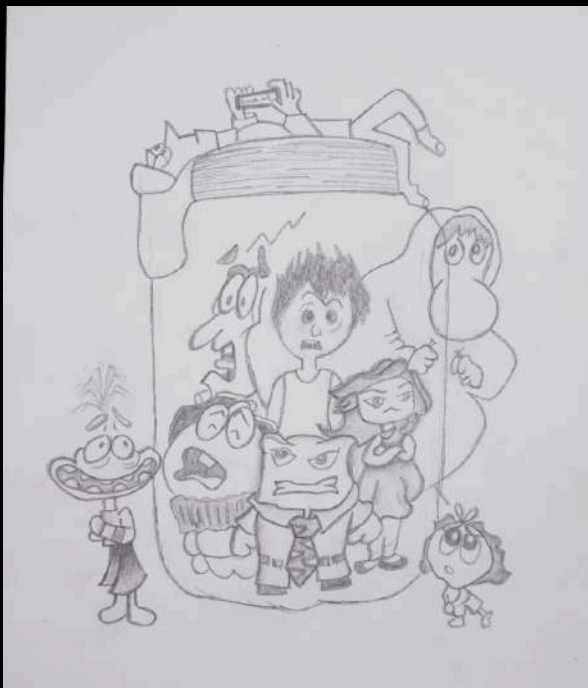
Govardhan PM - VII 



Adhvika K. - X 



Adhvika K - X 



Shruthi M. - X 



Harshita B - X 



Hasti A - XI 



Prachi S ~ X



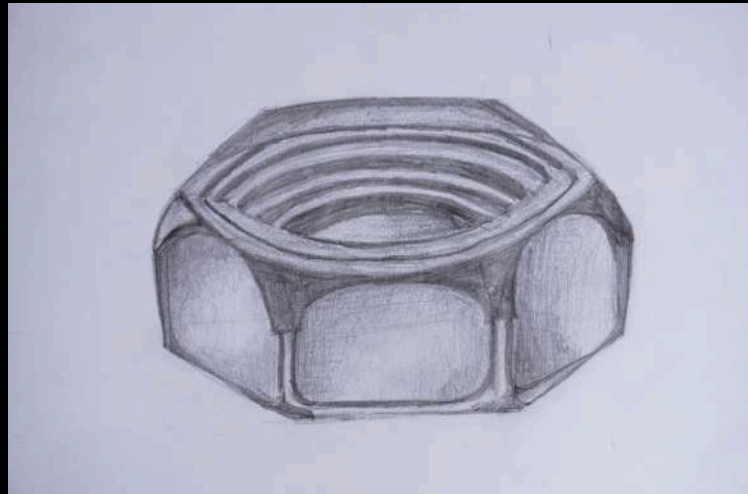
Tarushi A ~ XI



lokk Vishwaveda ~ XI



Aarush Kejriwal ~ VI



Chaitanya ~ X



Arth A ~ VII



Vivaan Jain ~ XII

Our country has a rich history in various dance traditions. Every state is a goldmine of artistic and cultural excellence. One such surreal masterpiece lies in the heart of Tamil Nadu, the Bharatnatyam. Which inspires emotions so encompassing that every thought disappears with the dance and all that is left is the moment itself.



CLASSIFIEDS



Harnessing Youth Potential Through Yajna Spirit | October 2025

Exemplifying this quality is our one and only, Shri Ram! From serving with courage and sacrificing his throne for Dharma. From accepting exile joyfully to fighting Ravana selflessly. His spirit, his valor, his yajna were all for societal welfare. He is indeed - Maryada Purushottam.



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THE CROSSROADS

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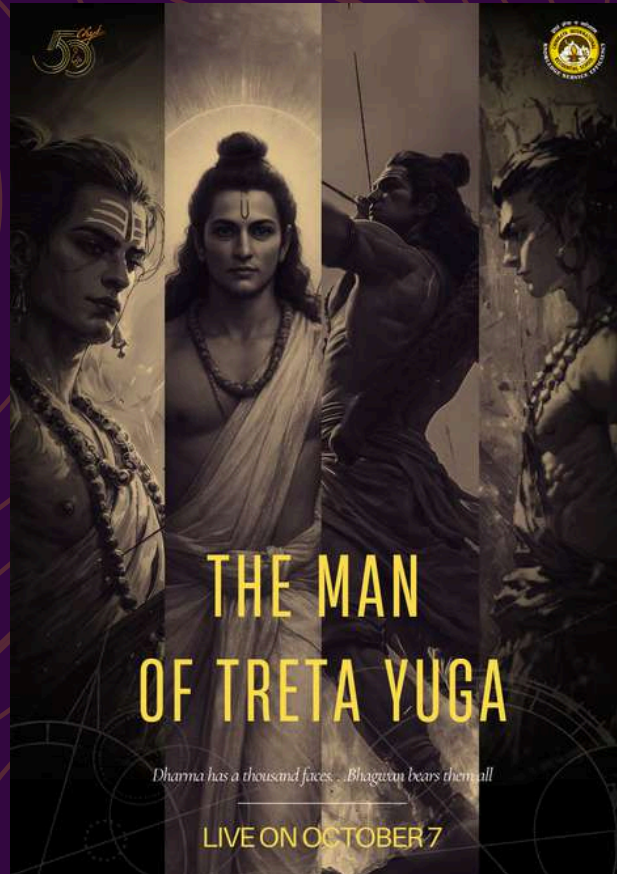
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RAM - THE MAN OF TRETA YUGA

Cast aside cultural weakness and the 'mediocrity of colonization,' proudly embrace our indigenous identity! Inspired by Shri Ram's ultimate sacrifices, we believe the time is now, with Ram Lalla's manifestation in Ayodhya, to halt all anti-Hindu narratives. This is our invitation to the "Anand Utsav 2025"—"Shri Ram - The Man of Treta Yuga"

October 7th, 7:00 PM
Venue - Vraj Auditorium

Don your Kurtas and Wear your Tilaks! Don't forget to bring your identity with you as you re-kindle the flame of Ram Rajya within!

Our gratitude to the CIRS management for giving flight to our initiative.

Chinmaya International Residential School

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